

Excellence Health System

Appeal Request — Reconsideration of Adverse Determination

Patient Name: Margaret Sullivan
MRN: 92315874
Member ID: MBR-00412

DOB: 1955-11-03
Original Denial Date: 2026-07-28
Appeal Filed Date: 2026-08-04

Appeal Level: Level 1 — Internal Appeal

REASON FOR APPEAL

This is a formal appeal to overturn the adverse determination (denial) issued on 2026-07-28 for inpatient admission for Acute on Chronic Systolic Heart Failure (I50.23). The denial letter stated that the patient did not meet medical necessity criteria.

CLINICAL RATIONALE FOR RECONSIDERATION

The denial failed to account for the following clinical evidence:

- BNP: 3,200 pg/mL — critically elevated, consistent with severe decompensated HF
- O2 Sat: 87% on room air — moderate hypoxemia requiring supplemental oxygen
- Bilateral 3+ pitting edema to the knees with JVD present
- Chest X-Ray showing bilateral pleural effusions and pulmonary vascular congestion
- Patient required IV Furosemide 80mg bolus followed by continuous drip
- EF documented at 20% on bedside echocardiogram (baseline 25%)

POLICY REFERENCE

Per policy UM-CHF-001 (Acute Congestive Heart Failure Admission), the patient meets the following criteria for inpatient admission:

- Criterion 1: O2 saturation below 90% — MET (87%)
- Criterion 2: BNP > 500 pg/mL — MET (3,200 pg/mL)
- Criterion 3: IV diuretic requirement — MET (IV Lasix drip initiated)
- Criterion 4: Acute worsening from baseline — MET (EF declined from 25% to 20%)

REQUESTED SERVICE

Inpatient admission to telemetry unit for acute decompensated heart failure management including IV diuresis, hemodynamic monitoring, and cardiology consultation.

KEY EVIDENCE CITED

- ED Provider Note dated 2026-07-28
- Echocardiogram Report dated 2026-07-28
- Chest X-Ray Report dated 2026-07-28
- Laboratory Results (BNP, Creatinine, Troponin)

FINANCIAL INFORMATION

Estimated cost of requested service: \$18,500.00
Diagnosis Category: Cardiology — Heart Failure

APPELLANT INFORMATION

Appellant Type: Provider

Attending Physician: Dr. Priya Sharma, MD, FACC

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CONCLUSION

Based on the clinical evidence above, we respectfully request that the denial be overturned and the inpatient admission be authorized. The patient clearly met all applicable criteria under policy UM-CHF-001 at the time of the original review.

Failure to authorize admission poses a significant clinical risk to this patient.